government.[103] By February 1923 the viceroy was able to report that the issue of the Caliph had caused little bad feeling against the new Turkish government.[104] This, of course, was all good news to the Indian government. The admittance, however, that the dissolution of the Caliph was actually of little practical consequence brought scoffs from the Foreign Office. Curzon argued that this mistake on India's part now meant that the Foreign Office was justified 'in not attaching the slightest value to any future representation of the Govt. of India in European politics'.[105]

Despite Curzon's mocking, the reaction of Indian Muslims to the actions of the Turkish Assembly is not so surprising when the matter is considered further. For one thing, the fact that the new Kemalist government itself chose to abolish the Sultanate, rather than having it forced upon it by the Allies, is a crucial factor in Muslim reaction. Indeed, the Caliphate movement had never really been about the issue of the Caliph per se. The plight of Turkey and the Caliph had instead been seen by Muslims as an embodiment of the erosion of Islamic power by the Christian western nations. The fact that the new Turkish government under Kemal had successfully challenged the Allies and the terms of the Treaty of Sèvres, was a welcome demonstration of Islamic power to Indian Muslims that helped soften the blow of the dissolution of the Sultanate/Caliphate.[106] Indeed, for the average Muslim the complexities of the Caliphate issue was probably more than they could appreciate, but it had been a convenient rallying point for anti-British agitation. The Foreign Office itself had previously argued this when it had been trying to undermine the Indian government's fear of the Caliphate problem.[107] However, as already noted, what London failed to grasp is that regardless of the legitimacy of the form which Muslim agitation took, the result was still the same for the Indian government. As Reading pointed out in January and repeated in February of 1923, while the dissolution of the Caliphate had been reasonably well received in India, the government still had to be careful what it said on the matter, lest it be accused of complicity in the Turkish decision and re-inflamed Muslim opinion.[108] Even after the complete abolition of the Caliphate in 1924, Turkey still received the loyalty of Indian Muslims.[109] Islamic Turkey had more leeway when it came to Muslim issues than did Christian, imperial Britain.